Enable or Delete Launch Darkly feature toggles in ODC

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1. Summary
2. General Information
    3. Pre-requisites
    Inputs for execution
    Soak periods for enabling/disabling
    Technical requirements
    Communication
    Expected duration
4. Implementation Plan
    4.1. Implementation actions
        4.1.A. Enabling Feature Toggle
            Rollback plan for enabling Feature Toggle
        4.1.B. Decommissioning Feature Toggle
            Rollback plan for decommissioning Feature Toggle
        4.1.C. Archiving Feature Toggle
    4.2. Testing and validation plan
5. Post Implementation
6. Other
7. Useful links/Related articles

1. Summary

As you can see in the ODC Portal RFC catalog, most RFC requests are related to Feature Toggles that we want to enable remotely, through Launch Darkly. Usually, those changes have low risk and impact, because the code was previously promoted through the pipelines, and tested in the CICD

This operation has the same risk/impact of having a button in the Portal that the customer could click when they want to enable a new feature. We just don’t want to provide that experience, and we want to enable it for the whole ring at the same time, or specific customers/tenants when the feature is in an Early Access Program (EAP).

These RFC requests to enable a feature toggle in a specific ring or for a specific customer, are time-consuming for the owner teams, reviewers, and approvers when there's nothing much to validate, and often delay the feature enabling on the ODC Portal side.

That being said, we would like to promote these changes to Standard, at least when the risk and impact are low. We should still request review and approval for requests with a medium/high impact or risk.

2. General Information

Change Type	Standard
Change Risk	Low
Downtime Involved	No
Rollback Available	Yes
Implementation Team	Any ODC Consoles team
Component(s)/Asset(s)	All ODC Consoles (ODC Portal)
Impact Description	No impact anticipated

Updated Jan 14 Edit

Inputs for execution

- Feature Toggle created in Launch Darkly
- Project on LaunchDarkly: `unified-experience`
- Feature toggle identifier: e.g. `TG_<ConsoleAcronym>_<ToggleContext>`
- Access to Grafana (when decommissioning an existing Feature toggle)

Soak periods for enabling/disabling

For enabling/disabling a feature toggle the following soak period must be applied and follow the ring's sequence.

Ring	Minimum Bake Period	Recommended Bake Period
-2 (TEST)	*no baking*	5 minutes
-1 (STAGE)	*no baking*	5 minutes
+1 (OSALL)	*no baking*	5 minutes
+2 (EA)	1h	4 hour
+3 (GA)	8h	2 days

- More details can be found Enable or Delete Launch Darkly feature toggles in ODC | Expected duration

Technical requirements

- Access to Launch Darkly and the Unified Experience project https://app.launchdarkly.com/projects/unified-experience/flags?env=production&env=production&selected-env=production

Communication

- For releases that follow the rings' sequence, the communication should be done with a release note

know that the feature is now enabled for their tenant

Expected duration

N/A

4. Implementation Plan

4.1. Implementation actions

4.1.A. Enabling Feature Toggle

This MUST be done in a progressive rollout approach, starting with the negative rings before going to the positive rings.

1. Go to the feature toggle page in Launch Darkly
2. Enable targeting rules if disabled
3. Add a new custom rule or edit an existing rule, if it already exists
4. Depending on the use case, choose one of the options below:
    a. Add/edit rule for a specific ring
        i. Description: write a meaningful description
        ii. Context kind: `user`
        iii. Attribute: `Ring`
        iv. Operator: `is one of`
        v. Values: `-3`, `-2`, `-1`, `1`, `2`, `3`
            1. These values should **be added incrementally**, following the ring sequence, and validated before enabling the next ring. Please check Enable or Delete Launch Darkly feature toggles in ODC | Soak periods for enabling/disabling
            2. These values should be set as `str` (click on top of the value to switch types between `num` and `str`)
    b. Add/edit rule for a specific tenant
        i. Description: write a meaningful description
        ii. Context kind: `user`
        iii. Attribute: `TenantId` (or `TenantPrefix`)
        iv. Operator: `is one of`

5. Change the default rule to `False`

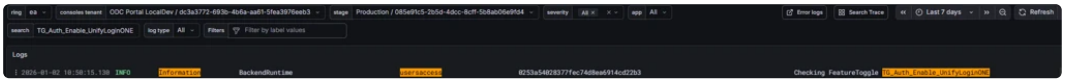
Rollback plan for enabling Feature Toggle

1. Go to the feature toggle page in Launch Darkly
2. Revert the steps executed in the implementation plan, which can include:
   a. Disable the targeting rules
   b. Remove the whole rule that was added
   c. Remove the added Ring, TenantId, or TenantPrefix for existing rules, which should continue to apply to other values. Access to Grafana Dashboard (link here) and validate that there are no uses of the feature toggle for the last 15 days. For that, use the search field and use the toggle name.

4.1.B. Decommissioning Feature Toggle

This process acts as a final validation that the code no longer relies on the toggle. **This MUST be done in a progressive rollout approach**, starting with the negative rings before going to the positive rings. It **MUST** be executed by the asset owner team.

1. Access to Grafana Dashboard (link here) and validate that there are no uses of the feature toggle for the last 15 days. For that, use the search field and use the toggle name.
   a. If the toggle is being used, there will be one log message per day (every 24 hours).



   b.
2. Go to the feature toggle page in Launch Darkly
3. Review the existing rules and:
   a. Remove/edit rule for a specific ring
      i. Description: <Ring X>
      ii. Context kind: `user`
      iii. Attribute: `Ring`
      iv. Operator: `is one of`
      v. Possible values: `-3`, `-2`, `-1`, `1`, `2`, `3`

removal must follow the soak period, please check Enable or Delete Launch Darkly feature toggles in ODC | Soak periods for enabling/disabling).

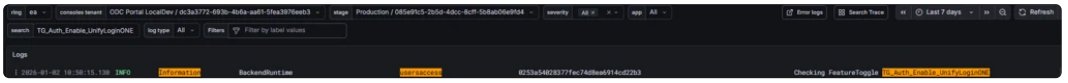
4. Change the default rule to `False` (last change). This value should be true before the decommissioning.

Rollback plan for decommissioning Feature Toggle

1. Go to the feature toggle page in Launch Darkly
2. Revert the steps executed in the implementation plan, which can include:
   a. Enabling the rule/ring that was removed
   b. Review the default rule back to True.

4.1.C. Archiving Feature Toggle

1. Access to Grafana Dashboard (link here) and validate that there are no uses of the feature toggle for the last 15 days. For that, use the search field and use the toggle name.
   a. If the toggle is being used, there will be one log message per day (every 24 hours).



   b.

2. The archive should only be done after the Enable or Delete Launch Darkly feature toggles in ODC | Decommissioning Feature Toggle
3. Ownership: It MUST be executed by the asset owner team.
4. Stability Period: The toggle has been at 100% (On) in Production for a minimum of 15 days with no reported regressions.

4.2. Testing and validation plan

Testing of these capabilities, hidden behind a feature toggle, should occur during the pipeline execution, which should test the asset both with and without the new capability.

5. Post Implementation

N/A - assuming that each feature hidden behind a Launch Darkly toggle was already tested when the code was promoted through the rings.

6. Other

N/A

7. Useful links/Related articles

- https://userpilot.com/
- POC: Userpilot integration on the ODC Portal
- [Alpha] Integrate Userpilot in ODC Portal - Threat model

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Sara Gonçalves

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André Grossinho

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